

# Northstar Labs Employee Handbook 2026

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## Annual leave

Beginning 1 January 2026, full-time employees receive 24 annual leave days per calendar year. Up to 8 unused days may be carried into the next calendar year; remaining unused days expire.

## Expense submission

Beginning 1 January 2026, reimbursable business expenses must be submitted within 30 calendar days of purchase. The former 45-day deadline no longer applies to new expenses.

## Professional learning

Employees may claim up to 1500 Northstar Credits per calendar year for approved courses, books, conferences, and professional certifications. The employee's manager must approve the learning plan before purchase, and unused allowance does not carry into the next year.

## Performance cycle

The 2026 performance cycle includes formal review checkpoints in June and December. Managers may hold additional development conversations, but those conversations do not replace either documented checkpoint.